

UTT Chapter 03 Assignment

Hello again!

As the semester is moving forward, my homework is piling up and classes are getting a lot harder. I thought taking a Basket Weaving elective would be a piece-of-cake class, but I was definitely wrong. Don't laugh at me. It's been a lot of work!

As part of our freshman orientation, we had to attend a cultural event last weekend. It did interfere with intramural practices, but it was also very interesting. We went to a Middle Eastern gathering where they showcased the food, dress, and traditions of Islam. Most of the food was really good, and it was neat to see how another culture lives.

I sat next to Muhammad, a student I recognized from one of my classes. He told me he grew up a Muslim in the Middle East. When we started talking about Islam, I realized how little I really knew. All I knew was that the attacks of 9/11 were carried out by radical Muslim terrorists, so I guess my mindset towards the religion was initially jaded. I asked Muhammad if he agreed with the 9/11 bombings, and he shook his head emphatically and told me he wasn't "that kind" of Muslim. I didn't know there was more than one kind, so I asked him what kind of Muslim he was.

He told me that he was a normal Muslim who follows the five pillars of Islam, lives closely in line with the Quran, and obeys Allah so he can earn his eternal salvation. I nodded my head in feigned comprehension as I pretended not to be completely ignorant about Islam (which I was), knowing that I'd probably learn about everything from the guys leading this cultural event. But unfortunately for me, this was more of an event for the Muslim students on campus and not a chance to learn about religion. I learned a bit about clothing and food, but they didn't really "teach" me anything about Islam, per se. I'm still kind of confused about the whole thing. I wonder if could you help me?

First off, **what is a Muslim, and what are the five pillars of Islam?** I've heard of Allah, but I don't really know what the difference is between the Muslim god and the Christian God. **What does Islam teach about the nature of God and human beings?** Muhammad mentioned that he believes all the biblical prophets are considered prophets of Islam, including Jesus. Can that be right? **What does Islam really teach about the Bible and Jesus?** He said following the Quran would get you into paradise. **What does Islam teach about salvation?** I feel really ignorant about the subject.

Well, it's late, so I should go to bed. But thanks for your help! I hope you're doing well!

Bye!

-Doug